Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 1, 2015 3:02 pm
Browser:	Chrome 44.0.2403.157 / Windows 7
IP Address:	72.44.188.98
Unique ID:	212033282
Location:	38.895099639893, -77.036399841309

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Sustainable funding and sustainable programming.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Connect, serve, change lives Volunteerism/service Grassroots empowerment
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	Volunteers/Chapters Decentralized/Network action
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	We have a hard time prioritizing activities. We tend to try to do it all or say all programs/themes are important which stretches resources too thin to be truly effective in any given area. We add work instead of being strategic about what work we're going to do. Part of this is a result of the industry and donor demands, but part of it is also that staff don't have a clear sense of what specific goals are or where we're headed beyond "financially stable" "well governed" etc.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	I think we need a more focused strategic plan that can prioritize certain activities over others so that staff can make smarter decisions about where they spend their time.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Greater integration of programs and volunteer network. More youth engagement at various levels. More engagement of the network through events, trainings, programs, virtual engagement, etc.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 2, 2015 5:21 pm
Browser:	Chrome 44.0.2403.157 / Windows 7
IP Address:	72.44.188.98
Unique ID:	212272264
Location:	38.895099639893, -77.036399841309

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Without a doubt, the financial stability of the organization is the most concerning part of Partners future. With A Ganar ending this September, Haiti Nutrition Security Program ending in May 2016, and Educafuturo ending in December 2016, Partners stands to lose roughly $5.7 million of annual revenue (out of approximately $8.5 million), representing well over $1 million of NICRA for administrative expenses such as salaries.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Partners does not currently highlight core principles that apply to all aspects of the organization. Currently each unit (Chapters, 100K Strong, AFS, Educafuturo, LE, etc.) has core principles that guide their behaviors and actions, but there is not a general universal set of core principles. In fact, it is difficult to claim that all of Partners' programs fall beneath Partners' current organizational mission. However, new teams of teams have been working to identify the common thread(s) that binds all of the groups. A case can be made that partnership (the broad definition, not just the Chapters) is the common thread that binds our organization. The Sustainable Partnership team of teams is working to share experiences and conduct secondary research to further flesh out this concept. The team believes that by fleshing out this approach, we will be able to better highlight Partners' core principles that are currently somewhat hidden.
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	One of Partners great assets is staff - ideologies, family-environment, and work ethic as opposed to technical expertise. Another great asset is Partners' regional expertise in Latin America and the Caribbean. Few organizations have as intimate understanding of the region as Partners.
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Partners biggest challenge is our lack of a competitive advantage over our competitors. This keeps us from competing for and winning new proposals that would improve the financial stability of the organization. Our lack of a competitive advantage is rooted in our inability to highlight expertise in any particular field. Partners is viewed as a generalist organization that dabbles in many different fields as opposed to having expertise in a certain field.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	As mentioned before, doubling down on Partners' ability to build and foster sustainable partnerships is key. By strongly framing and branding Partners as experts in fostering sustainable partnerships (broadly speaking), we could have a significant competitive advantage over our competitors. While there are a number of partnership building firms in the private sector, it is not a main focus of many non-profits.

Definition:

Strategic planning is a systematic process aimed at identifying and addressing specific issues in a participatory manner in order to attain the desired outcomes. The process takes into consideration contextual environmental issues and has specific goals and objectives.

Distinctive-Characteristics:

1) It has a direction and lifespan.
2) It has short-term and long-term goals.
3) It has a list of priorities covering 3, 5, or 10 years.

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Why do strategic planning?

- It helps organizations have good governance/leadership.
- It allows organizations to distinguish themselves from other groups doing similar work.
- It helps organizations develop policies.
- It gives organizations greater status and integrity.
- It helps organizations be focused and transparent.
- It allows organizations to be proactive rather than reactive.

What are the benefits of strategic planning?

- It helps avoid competition and enhances opportunities for partnership with other organizations.
- It provides others with a clear idea of what the organization does.
- It is good for beneficiaries.
- It helps in identifying goals, missions, and visions for the organization.
- It creates a sense of ownership.
- It promotes a commitment to good results.
- It encourages support from donors and other organizations.
- There is transparency in working systems among participants.
- It helps in the evaluation of time and work.

When should an organization do strategic planning?

- When starting an organization
- When the priorities, mission, and vision have changed
- When external factors negatively impact the organization
- When an organization needs to be more focused

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Partners of the Americas' 4 Strategic Goal Pillars

1) Build a Financially Sustainable Organization

2) Strengthen Partner's Network

3) Maintain a Well-Governed, Transparent and Accountable Organization

4) Evaluation & Communicate Partners' Impact & Value

Build a Financially Sustainable Organization

1) Diversify Partners' restricted and unrestricted revenue portfolio by cultivating relationships with "non-traditional donors"

2) Maintain a total operating budgeting of $16-$18M

3) Set up a well-functioning, revenue generating Limited Liability Company to increase the discretionary funds in the Partners of the Americas' Foundation.

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Strengthen Partners' Network

1) Improve functionality and accessibility of the PartnersConnect online database of members, affiliates, volunteers and supporters

2) Increase network affiliate enrollment via website portal, particularly individual and institutional recruitment through a membership retention plan with clearly defined value and benefits

3) Build financial management, leadership, program implementation the capacity of Chapters by providing tangible benefits that enhance their competitiveness for grants and overall sustainability.

Maintain a Well-Governed, Transparent and Accountable Organization

1) Earn and Maintain certificates of good governance (i.e. Better Business Bureau)

2) Strengthen and Diversify the leadership and fundraising capacity of Partners' Boards of Directors

3) Find an auditable method of calculating the full value of Partners counterpart and earned media match to enhance our competitiveness for winning grants and contracts

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Evaluate & Communicate Partners Impact & Value

1) Unify Partners' image and brand and simplify our mission statement to raise public awareness of our work

2) Create unified system to map Partner's network and measure our local and program-related impact

3) Package, sell and protect the intellectual property rights of Partners' most effective practices

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 1, 2015 1:22 pm
Browser:	Firefox 40.0 / Windows 7
IP Address:	72.44.188.98
Unique ID:	212014741
Location:	38.895099639893, -77.036399841309

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	I am concerned that we are pursuing too many large USG opportunities that pull us away from our long-term core competencies and create an infrastructure that can only be maintained by winning more opportunities of these types. Given that these opportunities are highly competitive and beyond our control to shape, I consider it a high risk high return strategy that may not be sustainable in the long-term.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	I believe that Partners fundamentally believes that creating and working through long-term partnerships is the most effective way to change lives. I believe that Partners gives special value to service and volunteering, although these are not elements of all our programs. I believe that Partners believes that it is only by working through local partners (defined in the broadest sense) can we address the real challenges and opportunities of our communities. No magic solutions helicoptered in.
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	1. Deep, diverse and committed network. 2. Programmatic experience and proven models. 3. Trust of key partners.
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Focusing our efforts on developing programs and acquiring resources that are most targeted to our competitive advantage. [Corollary: Learning to say no if something takes us off our game.]
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	Focus our programmatic development efforts more on developing and scaling models that we helped build ourselves. Spend more time in creative R&D with some outside engagement (invite thought leaders and consultants to our strategy sessions) to inspire us and avoid closed thinking, and less time preparing for reactive opportunities that we have little or no opportunity to shape. Have more frequent and more transparent discussions of options of future direction with senior staff and program directors, recognizing we will not all agree all the time, but that increased sharing of visions and observations will benefit Partners in the long run.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	To have a significantly stronger and growing member network that helps us build and implement programs. To have a more diverse program portfolio in terms of funding source, with increased support from the private sector, foundations and non-USG sources. To have a modest but significant inflow of unrestricted or less restricted resources, probably obtained through fee for service contracts that are mission-related.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 1, 2015 3:02 pm
Browser:	Chrome 44.0.2403.157 / Windows 7
IP Address:	72.44.188.98
Unique ID:	212033282
Location:	38.895099639893, -77.036399841309

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Sustainable funding and sustainable programming.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Connect, serve, change lives Volunteerism/service Grassroots empowerment
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	Volunteers/Chapters Decentralized/Network action
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	We have a hard time prioritizing activities. We tend to try to do it all or say all programs/themes are important which stretches resources too thin to be truly effective in any given area. We add work instead of being strategic about what work we're going to do. Part of this is a result of the industry and donor demands, but part of it is also that staff don't have a clear sense of what specific goals are or where we're headed beyond "financially stable" "well governed" etc.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	I think we need a more focused strategic plan that can prioritize certain activities over others so that staff can make smarter decisions about where they spend their time.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Greater integration of programs and volunteer network. More youth engagement at various levels. More engagement of the network through events, trainings, programs, virtual engagement, etc.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 2, 2015 5:21 pm
Browser:	Chrome 44.0.2403.157 / Windows 7
IP Address:	72.44.188.98
Unique ID:	212272264
Location:	38.895099639893, -77.036399841309

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Without a doubt, the financial stability of the organization is the most concerning part of Partners future. With A Ganar ending this September, Haiti Nutrition Security Program ending in May 2016, and Educafuturo ending in December 2016, Partners stands to lose roughly $5.7 million of annual revenue (out of approximately $8.5 million), representing well over $1 million of NICRA for administrative expenses such as salaries.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Partners does not currently highlight core principles that apply to all aspects of the organization. Currently each unit (Chapters, 100K Strong, AFS, Educafuturo, LE, etc.) has core principles that guide their behaviors and actions, but there is not a general universal set of core principles. In fact, it is difficult to claim that all of Partners' programs fall beneath Partners' current organizational mission. However, new teams of teams have been working to identify the common thread(s) that binds all of the groups. A case can be made that partnership (the broad definition, not just the Chapters) is the common thread that binds our organization. The Sustainable Partnership team of teams is working to share experiences and conduct secondary research to further flesh out this concept. The team believes that by fleshing out this approach, we will be able to better highlight Partners' core principles that are currently somewhat hidden.
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	One of Partners great assets is staff - ideologies, family-environment, and work ethic as opposed to technical expertise. Another great asset is Partners' regional expertise in Latin America and the Caribbean. Few organizations have as intimate understanding of the region as Partners.
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Partners biggest challenge is our lack of a competitive advantage over our competitors. This keeps us from competing for and winning new proposals that would improve the financial stability of the organization. Our lack of a competitive advantage is rooted in our inability to highlight expertise in any particular field. Partners is viewed as a generalist organization that dabbles in many different fields as opposed to having expertise in a certain field.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	As mentioned before, doubling down on Partners' ability to build and foster sustainable partnerships is key. By strongly framing and branding Partners as experts in fostering sustainable partnerships (broadly speaking), we could have a significant competitive advantage over our competitors. While there are a number of partnership building firms in the private sector, it is not a main focus of many non-profits.

In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	In 3-5 years Partners should begin looking at ways to expand outside of Latin America. The reality is that the majority of public funding is going to Africa and Asia, with less funding allocated to Latin America each year. Partners must be recognized as a global authority on building and fostering partnerships as opposed to merely a regional specialist.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 3, 2015 10:12 am
Browser:	IE 11.0 / Windows 8.1
IP Address:	69.57.254.230
Unique ID:	212371314
Location:	17.299999237061, -62.716701507568

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Funding. There are programs such as A Ganar that are struggling for money.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Respect, service, integrity, authenticity, courage
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	People Connections/Network Innovative programs
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Standardize processes and procedures for compliance. Right now every program has its own way to operate.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	Write policies and procedures that are applicable to all programs.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	I would like to see a grown company that excel in compliance.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 4, 2015 5:42 pm
Browser:	IE 11.0 / Windows 8.1
IP Address:	208.76.113.2
Unique ID:	212654011
Location:	39.083999633789, -77.152801513672

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	What concerns me most is the closure and/or inactivity of many chapters. I think there needs to be a much more focused push on strengthening chapters throughout the hemisphere. We started as a sort of sister-city group linking the US and Latin America, however many of these links seem to have weakened or vanished completely. PoA needs to have chapters, committed volunteers every where. This will in turn help raise awareness of the organization, engage more people, and secure more funds.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	People People-to-people connections Cultural Exchange Learning from each other Helping each other Self-Empowerment Mutual Respect Collaboration
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	1. Qualified and dedicated staff 2. Thousands of volunteers across the hemisphere committed for life 3. New linkages, affinity groups to strengthen our network
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	I think we've gotten too far away from the "people" citizens on the ground. As a non-profit ED, I do understand the need to follow the money, however I feel we may be spreading to thin in this pursuit. I think by strengthening our core - the people-to-people connections - we will be better poised to match funders that want to support what we do.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	Better engagement of chapters/members. We need chapters across the hemisphere doing outreach on PoA's behalf.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Stronger focus on chapters. Better name recognition across hemisphere

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 5, 2015 10:38 am
Browser:	Chrome 45.0.2454.85 / Windows 7
IP Address:	173.66.36.62
Unique ID:	212714375
Location:	38.80179977417, -77.210098266602

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	1.) Defining Who We Are: We are such a unique organization that doesn't easily fit into the boxes that most other organizations fall into. This is a strength if we capitalize on it, but it can also be a major weakness. Partners needs to develop internal clarity on the organization that we want to be and then stick to it. This could require re-branding, clarifying the mission, structural changes and more, but they will all be necessary in the coming years. 2.) Funding: A big part of what makes #1 such a problem is that we don't have the flexible resources that really allow organizations to define who they are. We are constantly at the mercy of our funders. Partners needs to develop an internal strategy to cut back our dependence on government grants at the level of a strategic plan. Maybe we shoot for 5 or 10% less dependence a year--but it has to be a serious commitment that everyone is aware of and takes responsibility for. Additionally, Partners must continue to commit to building relationships with the right people who can help us influence our destiny and introduce us to new potential funders in the corporate and non-traditional worlds. 3.) Strengthening our Chapters: In the next 10 years, we will for all intents and purposes lose the chapter network unless we continue to invest now. It becomes very difficult in lean financial times to do this well, which is why it is particularly of concern right now. We have been making good, recent progress in this area and need to be able to keep it up. Without our chapter network, we lose a big part of our competitive advantage, so it is in our best interest to take the steps we need to make it stronger.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	1. A belief in the power of partnerships. 2. A belief in mutual reciprocity. 3. A belief in the power of the individual to make changes in their own community. 4. Connect. Serve. Change Lives
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	1. Flexibility and willingness to change or do things differently. 2. We have on the ground connections which are highly valuable. 3. We have some tremendous areas of technical expertise which can be built on for even greater results.

In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	We take on way too much. We need to do less and better. The reason why we do this is because there is not universal agreement and understanding of our mission, so everyone interprets it in their own way. We also are completely at the mercy of the funding environment, so we do whatever we have to to get by. This is not a way to build a mission-centric organization. Partners desperately needs focus and internal clarity on what the top organizational priorities are at any one time. Constantly being in "emergency mode" doesn't allow future thinking and burns staff capital.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	First off, we need a strategic plan that is a REAL strategic plan and not just a requirement so we can check a box somewhere. Secondly, we need to interpret this strategic plan into specific goals for each admin unit and program. Units should draw their primary goals from the strategic plan and only after the bigger picture is drawn out should they add in more elective areas to work on.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	In 3-5 years, I would like to see Partners continue to maintain funding at least at the $12-15 million level, but have our sources of funding change dramatically. Partners should have a stronger chapter network that is actively engaged in our work of building partnerships and improving communities throughout the hemisphere. Partners' International Office helps foster all types of connections-some for-profit, some not-for-profit, but our ability to make the connections that matter as a tool of development increasingly brings us income and is increasingly recognized by our peers.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 5, 2015 10:13 pm
Browser:	Chrome 45.0.2454.85 / Windows 7
IP Address:	72.168.129.69
Unique ID:	212760511
Location:	38, -97

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Continued existence. WE need to continue to work on unrestricted income, but also examine how to save in many small ways instead of just focusing on big amount of money. We need to continue to grow the connections, reputations among donors, see out new donors
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Encouraging people and organizations around the hemisphere to connect with each other, focus on people to people and volunteerism, providing a way that individuals can be of service to others.
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	Volunteer spirit-lots of individuals giving of time and energy, invested staff willing to go ten extra miles, growing positive reputation among an evergrowing audience
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Volunteerism-since so much is dependent on volunteers, continuity is challenging. Also because of dependence on individuals-connection to big money donors is difficult and inconsistent;
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	Continue to encourage chapters to work on own funding, continue relationships with traditional forms of income while seeking out possible other donors
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Continuation and growth of programs like AGanar, FtoF, increase in number of partnerships, more unrestricted income

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 6, 2015 12:28 pm
Browser:	Chrome 45.0.2454.85 / Windows 7
IP Address:	71.82.128.103
Unique ID:	212801720
Location:	44.630699157715, -93.303398132324

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Diversifying sources of funding and developing revenue streams that provide predictable net revenue.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Service to others, an interest in connecting beyond borders and across cultures, the will and capacity to bring about change.
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	Its legacy and history, its membership and network, its ability to respond to changing needs.
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Diversity of revenue sources. This is a hard nut to crack that many organizations are struggling with.
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	The plans underway to establish an LLC and increase engagement with the private sector and other non-USG partners seems to be the right course in this environment.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Having the staff and leadership in place to address the issues raised in the questions above is important to consider in measuring success over the next 3-5 years.

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 9, 2015 9:20 am
Browser:	Chrome 45.0.2454.85 / Windows 7
IP Address:	201.38.9.98
Unique ID:	213214945
Location:	-10, -55

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Sustainability x Partners main asset. A permanent unrestricted project, such as (paid) Partners leadership Program Or decision on to whom focus for the inniatives and products Partnes members/partners organizations or general public. I assume we need to decide what it will be Partners main resource.
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	I liked the "connect and serve" but leadership is the main core value. I would vote for leadership based on exchange which leads to self esteem
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	networking, leadership, catalyst
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Sustainability the dependency on restricted funds connected to the lack of a permanent one or two umbrella unrestricted projects
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	Go deep in a strategic plan "swot" chart and look different ngos fund raising strategies
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Partners creating "Partners Interamerican leaders school"

Form Name:	Strategic Planning
Submission Time:	September 11, 2015 8:17 pm
Browser:	Firefox 40.0 / Windows 7
IP Address:	50.252.8.164
Unique ID:	213706091
Location:	38, -97

When you think about the future of Partners what concerns you the most? Please explain.	Leadership Board--Financial expertise,cultivation strategy Staff--CEO retirement Chapter--skills for existing chapter officers, skills for chapter leadership cultivation
In your view, what are Partners' core principles? (i.e. the shared values and vision that guide our behavior and actions)	Leveraging citizen diplomacy The commitment to the economic and the social values for cross-cultural dynamic change;
In your view, what are 1 to 3 of Partners greatest assets	1) Long history and long-standing profound relationships N-S 2) Connection to US Govt; validation by other hemispheric governments; 3) Identification and expertise in education, all levels.
In your view, what is Partners biggest challenge? What is the root cause of this challenge?	Financial and structural sustainability of our model. Root cause--failure to master new communications modes and related lack of visibility, connectivity, sense of impact externalities
In your view, what can Partners do to overcome this challenge?	Strengthen leadership at all levels in the organization, with emphasis on paradigm moving from technical to adaptive leadership and more focus on the strategic both internally and exte4rnally. We espouse and teach the importance of leadership but we don't practice it very well.
In 3-5 years, what would you like to see happening at Partners?	Partners of the Americas as the international nonprofit of reference for multi-cultural collaborative engagement in Education, Social work, Leadership, Sport for Development, and Ag/Environment. ~Decentralization of Program Development ~Integration of 100,000 Strong ~Young Professional engagement resulting in more vital, younger membership